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UAE Presidential Court

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan; His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, along with Their Highnesses the Supreme Council Members and Rulers of the Emirates, Sheikh Dr Sultan Bin Mohammed Al Qasimi of Sharjah; Sheikh Hamad Bin Mohammed Al Sharqi of Fujairah; Sheikh Saud Bin Rashid Al Mu'alla of Umm Al Quwain; Sheikh Saud Bin Saqr Al Qasimi of Ras Al Khaimah and Sheikh Ammar Bin Humaid Al Nuaimi, Crown Prince of Ajman, at an Eid Al Adha reception at Mushrif Palace.

PRESIDENT CALLS FOR PEACE, PROSPERITY ON EID

Leaders pray for blessings on nation as residents celebrate extended break

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.

Senior Associate Editor

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday called for peace, stability and prosperity in a message marking the start of Eid Al Adha

"I congratulate my brothers, the Rulers of the Emirates, all those who call the UAE home, and Muslims around the world on the occasion of Eid Al Adha," Sheikh Mohamed wrote on social media platform X.

"We pray that God bestows his blessings on our nation and grants peace, stability, and prosperity to all."

The President also sent congratulatory messages to kings, presidents and emirs of Islamic nations, wishing them and their countries and peoples continued progress, prosperity and stability.

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, and Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister

and Chairman of the Presidential Court, issued similar Eid greetings.

Celebrations across emirates

The messages came as UAE residents began an extended Eid Al Adha break, with private sector employees receiving four days off from May 26 to May 29, while public sector employees are enjoying a five-day holiday. Work across all sectors is scheduled to resume on Monday.

The long holiday weekend has also given families an opportunity to visit some of Dubai's most popular attractions ahead

of the summer season. Global Village, which had originally been scheduled to close on May 10, extended its season until May 31, allowing residents and tourists one final chance to visit during the Eid break.

This year's Eid Al Adha comes at a time of heightened regional uncertainty, as diplomatic efforts continue to seek a peaceful end to the Iran conflict.

The UN Security Council on Tuesday strongly condemned the recent drone strike targeting the UAE's Barakah nuclear power plant, warning that attacks on civilian nuclear facilities

pose serious risks to human life, infrastructure and the environment.

UN's deep concern

In a unanimous statement, the 15-member council described the attack as "a flagrant violation of international law" and expressed "deep concern over this dangerous escalation". The council demanded the "immediate and permanent cessation" of attacks and threats against civilian infrastructure in the UAE, including peaceful nuclear facilities.

The Security Council also re-

affirmed that the Barakah Nuclear Power Plant was designed, constructed and operated in accordance with the highest international safety standards under the oversight of the UAE's Federal Authority for Nuclear Regulation and in line with International Atomic Energy Agency requirements.

The statement further reiterated the council's "strong support" for the UAE's sovereignty and territorial integrity and its commitment to preserving peace and stability in the Middle East.

SEE ALSO P2-6, 11, 12

ENTERTAINMENT

Pakistani actress Meera says she wants Salman to see her Eid film | P16



BUSINESS

UAE banks to keep transfer systems running through Eid | P7

Dubai Eid gold price gap over India widens

Higher import duties, rupee weakness push buyers toward UAE market

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE

Your Money Editor

Dubai is strengthening its position as a cheaper destination for gold purchases compared with India, as higher import duties and a weaker rupee continue driving up domestic bullion prices in the Indian market.

India raised customs duty on gold imports from 6 per cent to 15 per cent effective May 13, according to an ICICI Bank Global Markets report. At the same time, the rupee has depreciated about 7 per cent this year, increasing the impact of elevated global bullion prices on local retail rates.

Stronger gold demand

UAE gold prices were trading near Dh499.75 per gram for 22K and Dh539.75 for 24K gold yesterday, while Indian prices climbed to around Rs145,650 per 10 grams for 22K and Rs158,890 for 24K.

The widening price gap has increased Dubai's appeal for Indian travellers and expatriates buying jewellery, coins and bullion.

Jewellers in Dubai also expect stronger gold demand this Eid Al Adha, a period that traditionally drives higher purchases of jewellery, coins and gifting products among residents and tourists. Retailers have been flagging recently how the widening price gap between the UAE and India could further boost buying activity this festive season.

ICICI Bank expects Indian gold prices to remain elevated through 2026 and 2027, forecasting prices could reach Rs180,000 per 10 grams next year. The widening price gap has increased Dubai's appeal for Indian travellers and expatriates buying jewellery, coins and bullion. Analysts said the UAE continues benefiting from lower taxes, transparent pricing and the dirham's peg to the US dollar.

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